

Blair to Burnham (1997–2026)

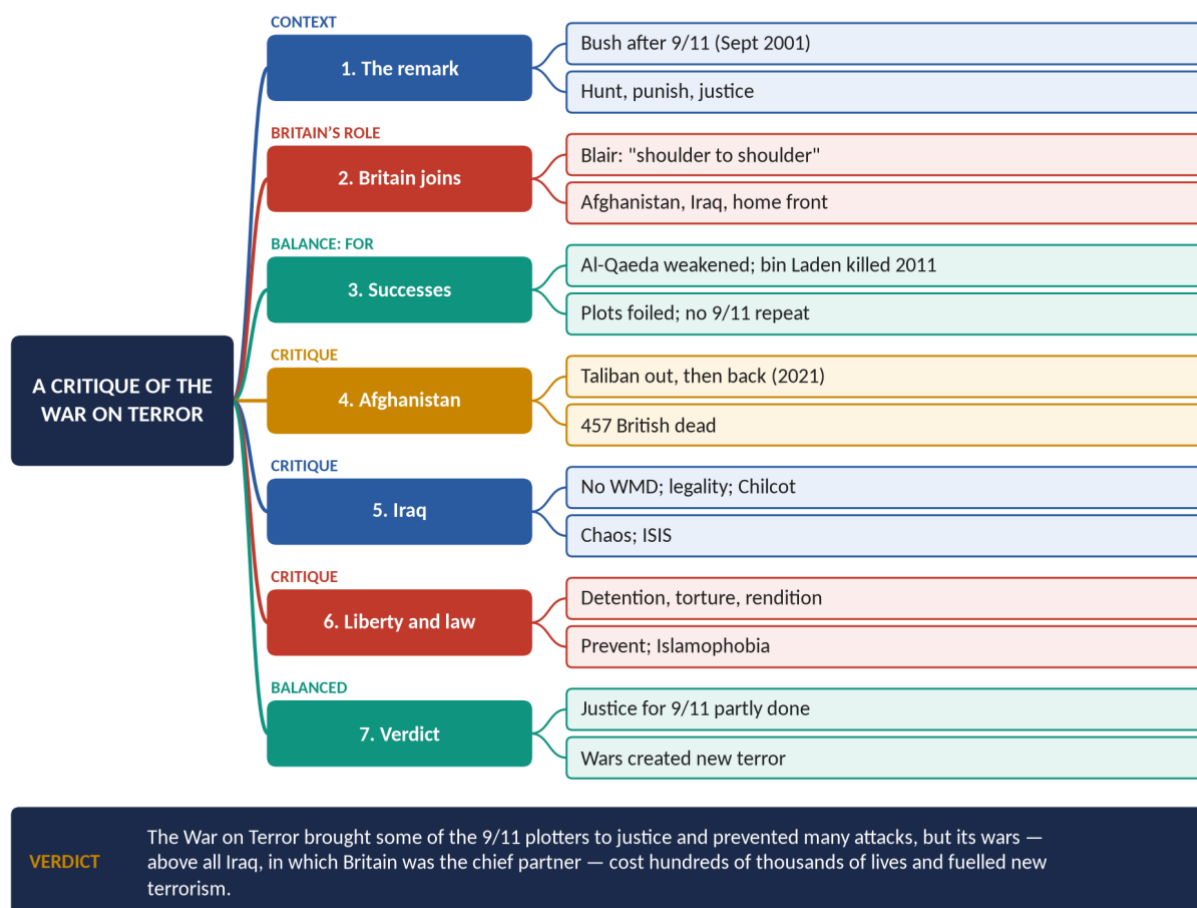
Every past question on New Labour, the War on Terror, the financial crisis, David Cameron, Brexit and Lady Diana — answered in full, in simple words, with answer maps

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2023 · Q7 · SECTION B

'We will find those who did it, we will smoke them out of their holes, we will get them running and we will bring them to justice.' In the context of this remark, present a balanced critique of the War on Terror with special emphasis on the role of Great Britain.

KEY WORDS "smoke them out" · "balanced critique" · "War on Terror" · "role of Great Britain"

IT DEMANDS Explain the remark (Bush, September 2001); then a balanced critique — successes and failures — with Britain's role at the centre.



All 13 past items (2015–2026): eight full answers and five short notes (two set twice); the eight past MCQs solved; five predicted questions with outlines.

Topic 10 of 10 · companion to T10KB (the Knowledge Base)

Contents

HOW TO USE THIS · Updating the contents

Right-click the contents → **Update Field** → **Update entire table**, before saving as PDF.

How to Use These Answers.....	7
Answer 1 · New Labour: Thatcherism by Other Means, or a Distinct Project?	8
The model answer.....	9
Introduction.....	9
Limb 1 · How New Labour differed from previous Labour governments.....	10
(1) Ownership and the market	10
(2) The trade unions	10
(3) Tax and the economy	10
(4) Voters and image	10
(5) Foreign policy	10
Limb 2 · Thatcherism by other means?	10
(6) The case for continuity.....	10
(7) The case for a distinct project.....	11
Answer 2 · 1997–2012: Renewal or Unresolved Contradictions?	13
The model answer.....	14
Introduction.....	14
Constitutional reform.....	14
(1) Renewal.....	14
(2) Contradictions	14
Foreign policy.....	15
(3) Renewal.....	15
(4) Contradictions	15
International identity	15
(5) Renewal.....	15
(6) Contradictions	15
Judgement	15
Answer 3 · Blair's War on Terror and US–British Relations	17
The model answer.....	18
Introduction.....	18
Limb 1 · The salient features of Blair's policy	18
(1) Solidarity with America	18
(2) A moral, interventionist doctrine.....	19
(3) Afghanistan (2001–)	19
(4) Iraq (2003)	19
(5) Security measures at home.....	19
(6) Diplomacy and "hearts and minds"	19
Limb 2 · The effect on US–British relations	19
(7) A closer relationship.....	19
(8) British influence — real but limited	20

(9) The costs for Britain	20
(10) Long-term effects	20
Answer 4 · "Smoke Them Out of Their Holes": A Balanced Critique of the War on Terror	21
The model answer	22
Introduction	22
The remark and the aims	23
(1) What Bush promised	23
(2) Britain's role	23
Achievements	23
(3) "Smoking them out" — partly achieved	23
(4) Britain's contribution	23
Failures and costs	23
(5) Iraq — the central failure	23
(6) Afghanistan — a lost war	24
(7) Justice and values	24
(8) Terrorism at home	24
(9) Political costs for Britain	24
Answer 5 · How the Financial Crisis Plunged Britain into Recession, and How It Responded	26
The model answer	27
Introduction	27
Limb 1 · How the crisis caused recession	27
(1) The American origins	27
(2) Britain's vulnerability	27
(3) The banking crisis	28
(4) From banking crisis to recession	28
Limb 2 · How Britain responded	28
(5) The bank rescue (October 2008)	28
(6) Monetary policy	28
(7) Fiscal stimulus	28
(8) International leadership	28
(9) The coalition's response (from 2010)	29
(10) Results	29
Answer 6 · The Financial Crisis: Impact, Two Responses and Long-Term Effects	30
The model answer	31
Introduction	31
Part 1 · The impact on politics and society	31
(1) Politics	31
(2) Society	31
Part 2 · How the two responses differed	32
(3) Labour's response (2008–2010): stimulus	32
(4) The Conservative-led response (2010–2016): austerity	32
Part 3 · The long-term effects	33
(5) Of Labour's response	33
(6) Of austerity	33
(7) For British politics	33
Answer 7 · David Cameron's Foreign Policy, with Special Reference to the Middle East	35
The model answer	36

Introduction	36
General features	36
(1) "Liberal conservatism"	36
(2) Commercial diplomacy	36
(3) Aid and soft power	36
(4) Defence cuts and the "Iraq syndrome"	36
(5) Europe and Russia	36
The Middle East	37
(6) The Arab Spring (2011)	37
(7) Libya (2011) — his defining intervention	37
(8) Syria	37
(9) ISIS	38
(10) Iran	38
(11) The Gulf	38
(12) Israel and Palestine	38
(13) Afghanistan	38
Assessment	38
Answer 8 · The Advantages and Disadvantages of Brexit for England	40
The model answer	41
Introduction	41
The advantages	42
(1) Sovereignty and democracy	42
(2) Money	42
(3) Trade policy	42
(4) Regulatory freedom	42
(5) Immigration	42
(6) Agriculture and fishing	42
The disadvantages	42
(7) Trade with Europe	42
(8) The economy	43
(9) Immigration — an unexpected result	43
(10) The Union	43
(11) Influence and other losses	43
Analysis	43
Short Notes	45
Reforms under David Cameron (also 2025 Q8(c))	45
Britain's Role in the War on Terror	45
Lady Diana (also 2026 Q8(b): Lady Diana Spencer)	46
Part Two — The Past MCQs, Solved	47
CSS 2024 · MCQ 10	47
CSS 2025 · MCQ 15	47
CSS 2025 · MCQ 18	47
CSS 2025 · MCQ 20	47
CSS 2026 · MCQ 11	48
CSS 2026 · MCQ 12	48
CSS 2026 · MCQ 13	48
CSS 2026 · MCQ 20	48

Part Three — Five Predicted Questions, with Outlines 50

Predicted 1 · "Assess the significance of devolution and the Good Friday Agreement for the United Kingdom." 50

Predicted 2 · "Evaluate the Blair government's domestic record, 1997–2007." 50

Predicted 3 · "Why did Britain vote to leave the European Union in 2016?" 50

Predicted 4 · "Discuss the political instability in Britain from 2016 to 2024." 50

Predicted 5 · "How did the Covid-19 pandemic affect British politics and society?" 50

How to Use These Answers

#	Paper	Question (short)	Answer
1	2025 Q6	New Labour v previous Labour governments; Thatcherism or a new project?	Answer 1
2	2026 Q7	1997–2012: renewal or unresolved contradictions?	Answer 2
3	2021 Q8	Blair's War on Terror; its effect on US–British relations	Answer 3
4	2023 Q7	Bush's "smoke them out": a balanced critique of the War on Terror	Answer 4
5	2023 Q8	How the financial crisis caused recession; Britain's response	Answer 5
6	2025 Q7	The crisis: impact; Labour and Conservative responses; long-term effects	Answer 6
7	2016 Q7	Cameron's foreign policy, with reference to the Middle East	Answer 7
8	2017 Q8	Advantages and disadvantages of Brexit	Answer 8
9	2024 Q7(b) · 2025 Q8(c)	Short note: reforms under Cameron (set twice)	Short note
10	2026 Q8(a)	Short note: Britain's role in the War on Terror	Short note
11	2018 Q8(c) · 2026 Q8(b)	Short note: Lady Diana (set twice)	Short note

Every answer has: the question as set · its **answer map** · **decoding the question** · a **model answer** with numbered headings, figures and a verdict · **why this answer scores**.

Answer 1 · New Labour: Thatcherism by Other Means, or a Distinct Project?

THE QUESTION · CSS 2025 · Q6 · Section B · 20 marks

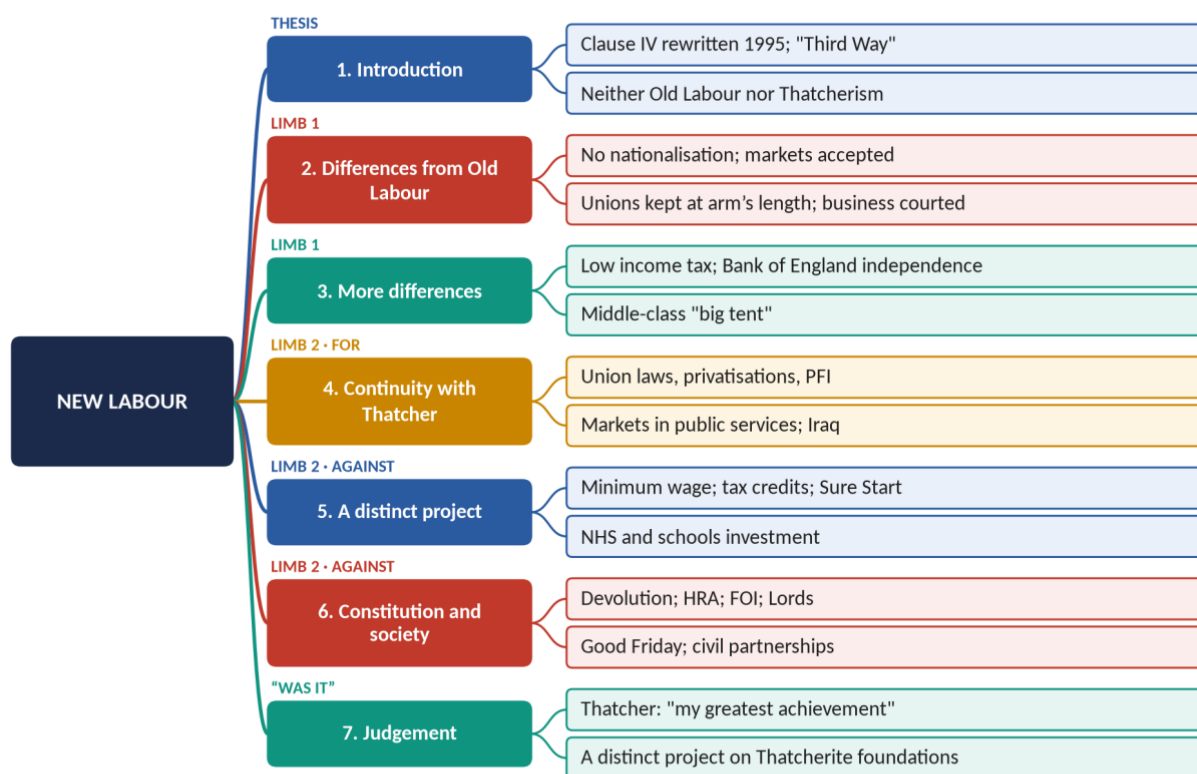
How did the policies of New Labour under Tony Blair differ from those of previous Labour governments? Was it a continuation of Thatcherism by other means, or did it represent a distinct political project?

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2025 · Q6 · SECTION B

How did the policies of New Labour under Tony Blair differ from those of previous Labour governments? Was it a continuation of Thatcherism by other means, or did it represent a distinct political project?

KEY WORDS "differ" · "previous Labour governments" · "continuation of Thatcherism" · "distinct political project"

IT DEMANDS Two limbs. (1) Compare New Labour with Old Labour (1945–51, 1964–79). (2) Judge: Thatcherism continued, or something new? Weigh continuity against change.



VERDICT

New Labour broke with Old Labour by accepting markets and low taxes, and so continued parts of Thatcherism; but its investment in public services, attack on poverty and constitutional reform made it a distinct political project.

Figure 1 · The answer map for CSS 2025 · Q6 · Section B: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

Two limbs. (1) "How did the policies of New Labour under Tony Blair differ from those of previous Labour governments?" — compare with **Attlee** (1945–51) and **Wilson/Callaghan** (1964–79): ownership, unions, tax, spending, voters. (2) "Was it a continuation of Thatcherism by other means, or did it represent a distinct political project?" — weigh the evidence of **continuity** with Thatcher against the evidence of a **new** project, and decide.

The model answer

Introduction

New Labour was the name **Tony Blair** gave to the Labour Party he led from **1994** and took to three election victories (**1997, 2001, 2005**). It broke decisively with the Labour governments of the past — abandoning **nationalisation**, keeping the **trade unions** at arm's length and accepting **low income taxes** and the **market economy**. In doing so it kept much of what **Margaret Thatcher** had built. But New Labour was not simply Thatcherism with a kinder face: its investment in **public services**, its attack on **poverty** and its **constitutional revolution** made it a **distinct political project** — the "**Third Way**" — built on Thatcherite foundations.

OLD LABOUR, THATCHERISM AND NEW LABOUR

Continuity and change

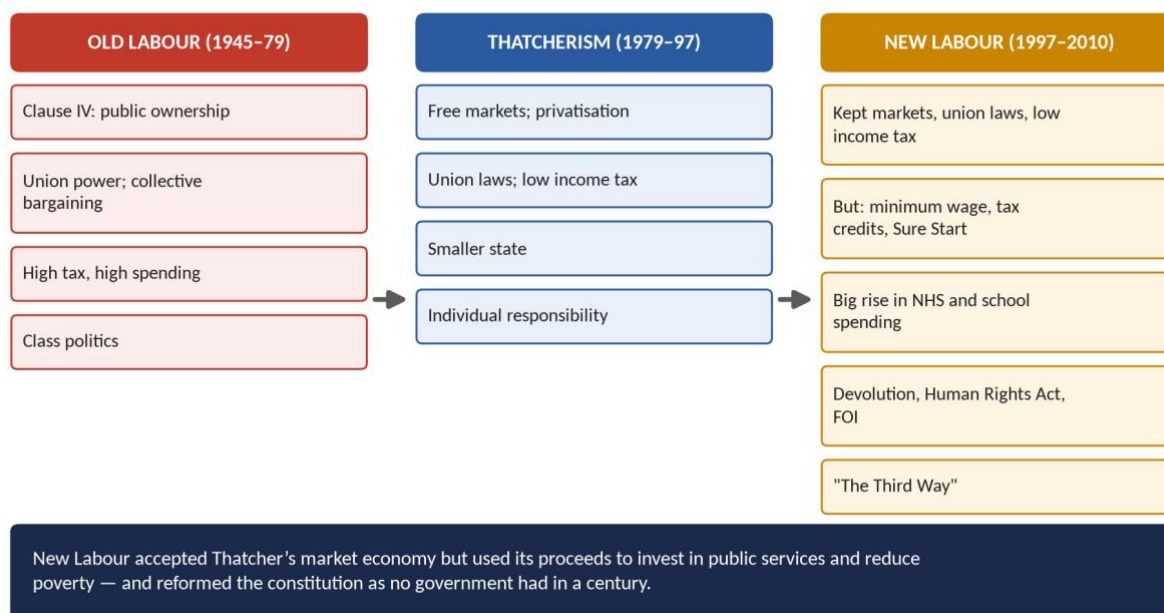


Figure 2 · Old Labour, Thatcherism and New Labour.

Limb 1 · How New Labour differed from previous Labour governments

(1) Ownership and the market

- **Old Labour:** **Clause IV** (1918) committed the party to common ownership; **Attlee** nationalised coal, railways, gas, electricity and steel (1945–51); Wilson renationalised steel (1967).
- **New Labour:** Blair rewrote **Clause IV (1995)** to praise "the enterprise of the market and the rigour of competition"; no privatised industry was renationalised; the **Private Finance Initiative** used private money to build hospitals and schools.

(2) The trade unions

- **Old Labour:** the unions founded and financed the party and were partners in government ("beer and sandwiches at Number Ten"; the Social Contract, 1974–79).
- **New Labour:** kept Thatcher's union laws; "fairness, not favours"; more money from business donors.

(3) Tax and the economy

- **Old Labour:** high, progressive taxes (top rates up to 83 per cent in the 1970s); demand management; frequent sterling crises (1949, 1967, 1976).
- **New Labour:** promised **no rise in income tax**; cut the basic rate; gave the **Bank of England independence (1997)**; "prudence" and the fiscal rules; low inflation.

(4) Voters and image

- **Old Labour:** the party of the **industrial working class**.
- **New Labour:** a "**big tent**" — "Middle England", business, the aspirational; media management; the support of *The Sun*.

(5) Foreign policy

- **Old Labour:** often divided over nuclear weapons and America; Wilson kept out of Vietnam.
- **New Labour:** "**liberal interventionism**" — Kosovo, Sierra Leone, Afghanistan and Iraq alongside the USA.

Limb 2 · Thatcherism by other means?

(6) The case for continuity

1. **Markets:** privatisation kept; PFI expanded; markets and choice brought into the NHS and schools (foundation hospitals, academies).
2. **The unions:** Thatcher's laws kept.
3. **Tax:** low income tax; light-touch regulation of the **City**.
4. **Law and order:** tough on crime; ASBOs; more prisoners.
5. **The USA:** close alliance, as with Thatcher and Reagan — Iraq.

6. **Thatcher's own verdict:** asked her greatest achievement, she reportedly said "**Tony Blair and New Labour**" (2002).
7. **Critics on the left:** **Stuart Hall** called it "**the great moving nowhere show**" (1998).

(7) The case for a distinct project

1. **Social justice:**
 - the **National Minimum Wage (1999)** — opposed by the Conservatives;
 - **tax credits** for working families and children;
 - a pledge to **end child poverty** (it fell by about 600,000 children);
 - **Sure Start** children's centres.
2. **Public services:** NHS spending roughly **doubled** in real terms; more teachers, doctors and nurses; waiting lists cut sharply; school rebuilding — the opposite of Thatcher's "rolling back the state".
3. **The constitution** — the greatest change in a century:
 - **devolution** (Scotland, Wales, 1999);
 - the **Good Friday Agreement** (1998);
 - the **Human Rights Act** (1998);
 - the **Freedom of Information Act** (2000);
 - removal of most **hereditary peers** (1999);
 - the **Supreme Court** (2005/2009).

Thatcher had centralised power; New Labour dispersed it.

4. **Social liberalism:** civil partnerships (2004), equality laws, a more multicultural Britain — against Thatcher's "Victorian values".
5. **Internationalism:** aid doubled; DfID; debt relief; climate change — very different from Thatcher's priorities.
6. **"Redistribution by stealth":** taxes on business and property, and tax credits, shifted resources to the poor.

Area	Continuity with Thatcher	Break with Thatcher
Economy	Markets, privatisation, low income tax	Minimum wage; tax credits
State	PFI; choice	Big increase in public spending
Society	Tough on crime	Anti-poverty; social liberalism
Constitution	—	Devolution, HRA, FOI, Lords
World	US alliance	Aid, debt relief, climate

VERDICT · Conclusion

New Labour differed sharply from previous Labour governments: it abandoned nationalisation, distanced itself from the unions, accepted low income taxes and the market, and reached out to middle-class voters. In that sense it continued key parts of Thatcherism. But it used the proceeds of a market economy to rebuild public services and reduce poverty, and it transformed the constitution in ways Thatcher would never have accepted. It was therefore a distinct political project — the "Third Way" — built on Thatcherite foundations.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

Limb 1 compares New Labour with Old Labour **area by area**, with named governments ·

Limb 2 gives the **case for continuity** and the **case for a distinct project**, with evidence and quotations (Thatcher, Hall) · a **comparison table** · a clear, balanced verdict.

Answer 2 · 1997–2012: Renewal or Unresolved Contradictions?

THE QUESTION · CSS 2026 · Q7 · Section B · 20 marks

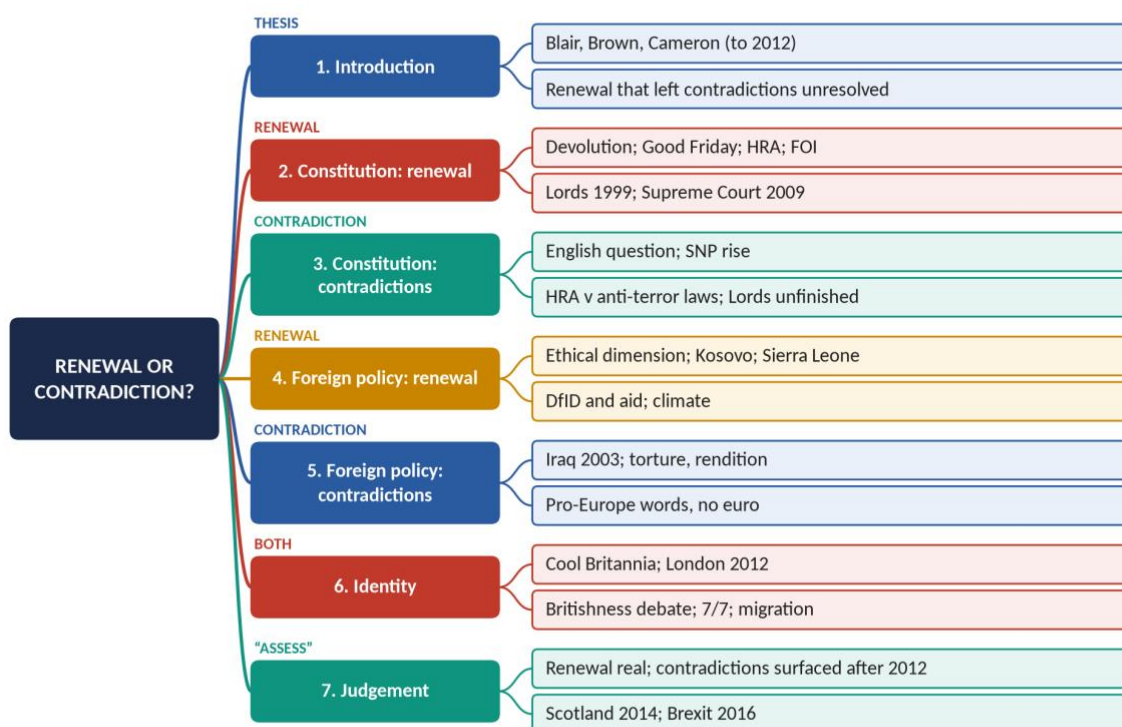
From 1997 to 2012, Britain saw dramatic shifts in foreign policy, constitutional reform and international identity. Assess whether the period should be interpreted as one of renewal or of unresolved contradictions in British governance.

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2026 · Q7 · SECTION B

From 1997 to 2012, Britain saw dramatic shifts in foreign policy, constitutional reform and international identity. Assess whether the period should be interpreted as one of renewal or of unresolved contradictions in British governance.

KEY WORDS "1997 to 2012" · "foreign policy" · "constitutional reform" · "international identity" · "renewal" · "unresolved contradictions"

IT DEMANDS Test both interpretations across the three named areas, then judge. The best answers show that renewal itself produced contradictions.



VERDICT

The years 1997–2012 were a genuine period of renewal — devolution, rights, peace in Northern Ireland, a confident multicultural Britain — but they left contradictions over sovereignty, Europe, liberty and the Union that exploded after 2012.

Figure 3 · The answer map for CSS 2026 · Q7 · Section B; every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

"Assess whether" the period should be seen as **renewal** (a fresh start, modernisation) or as **unresolved contradictions** (tensions and inconsistencies left unsettled). The question names **three areas: foreign policy, constitutional reform and international identity**. Test both views in each area, then judge. The best answers show that renewal itself **created** the contradictions.

The model answer

Introduction

Between **1997** and **2012** Britain was governed by **Tony Blair** (1997–2007), **Gordon Brown** (2007–10) and, from 2010, **David Cameron's** coalition. These years saw a constitutional revolution, a new interventionist foreign policy and a confident, multicultural national image — symbolised by the **London Olympics** of **2012**. This answer argues that the period was a **genuine renewal**, but one that left deep **contradictions** — over the Union, rights and security, Europe, and the legitimacy of war — which were papered over until 2012 and then broke open in the **Scottish referendum** (2014) and **Brexit** (2016).

Constitutional reform

(1) Renewal

- **Devolution:** the **Scottish Parliament** and **Welsh Assembly** (**1999**); the **Mayor of London** (2000).
- **Peace:** the **Good Friday Agreement** (**1998**) ended thirty years of conflict in **Northern Ireland** with power-sharing.
- **Rights:** the **Human Rights Act** (**1998**); the **Freedom of Information Act** (**2000**).
- **Institutions:** most hereditary peers removed (**1999**); the **Supreme Court** (**2009**); **Bank of England independence** (1997).
- **Vernon Bogdanor** called it "**the new British constitution**".

(2) Contradictions

1. **The English question:** Scotland had its own parliament, but England had none; Scottish MPs voted on English laws (the **West Lothian question**).
2. **Devolution strengthened nationalism:** the **SNP** won power in Scotland (**2007**) and a majority (**2011**), leading to the **2014 independence referendum** — the opposite of what Labour intended.
3. **Rights v security:** the Human Rights Act clashed with anti-terror laws (Belmarsh detentions ruled unlawful, 2004; control orders).
4. **Unfinished reform:** the **Lords** remained unelected (the coalition's 2012 reform bill was abandoned); the **AV referendum** failed (**2011**).

Foreign policy

(3) Renewal

- An **"ethical dimension"** (Robin Cook, 1997).
- **Humanitarian intervention** that worked: **Kosovo (1999)** and **Sierra Leone (2000)**.
- **Development**: DfID (1997), aid doubled, debt relief, **Gleneagles (2005)**; climate leadership (the **Climate Change Act**, 2008).
- **Europe**: the Social Chapter, St Malo defence initiative.

(4) Contradictions

1. **Iraq (2003)**: an "ethical" government joined a war on false WMD claims, without a new UN resolution — the **Chilcot Report** (2016) was damning.
2. **Values and practice**: complicity in **rendition** and **torture** contradicted human-rights rhetoric.
3. **Europe**: Blair wanted Britain "at the heart of Europe" but kept out of the **euro** and ratified the **Lisbon Treaty** without a referendum — feeding Euroscepticism.
4. **The special relationship**: the "bridge" between the USA and Europe broke over Iraq.
5. **Libya (2011)**: intervention without a plan for the aftermath.

International identity

(5) Renewal

- **"Cool Britannia"**: a modern, creative, multicultural image.
- Social liberalism: civil partnerships (2004), equality laws.
- **London 2012**: a celebration of a diverse, confident nation.

(6) Contradictions

- **The Britishness debate**: Gordon Brown's call for shared British values reflected uncertainty about national identity in a devolved, diverse country.
- **7/7 (2005)**: home-grown terrorism challenged multiculturalism.
- **Immigration**: large-scale migration after the EU's enlargement (**2004**) produced a backlash and the rise of **UKIP**.
- **The economy**: a boom built on the City and debt ended in the **2008 crash** and austerity — undermining the image of a confident, prosperous Britain.

Judgement

Area	Renewal	Contradiction
Constitution	Devolution, peace, rights	English question; SNP; rights v security
Foreign policy	Kosovo, Sierra Leone, aid	Iraq; torture; Europe without the euro

Area	Renewal	Contradiction
Identity	Cool Britannia; London 2012	Britishness; 7/7; immigration; the crash

VERDICT · Conclusion

The years 1997–2012 were a genuine period of renewal: Britain's constitution was transformed, peace came to Northern Ireland, public services and social attitudes were modernised, and the country projected a confident, diverse identity to the world. But the renewal was incomplete and often inconsistent: devolution raised questions about England and the Union, an "ethical" foreign policy led to Iraq, a pro-European government stayed outside the euro, and a debt-fuelled boom ended in crisis. These unresolved contradictions exploded after 2012 — in the Scottish referendum of 2014 and the Brexit vote of 2016 — so the period is best seen as renewal that left its hardest questions unanswered.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

It tests **both interpretations** in **each of the three named areas** · **specific evidence** (Good Friday, HRA, Belmarsh, Kosovo, Chilcot, Lisbon, 7/7, London 2012) · the **link** between renewal and later crises (2014, 2016) · a summary table and a clear judgement.

Answer 3 · Blair's War on Terror and US–British Relations

THE QUESTION · CSS 2021 · Q8 · Section B · 20 marks

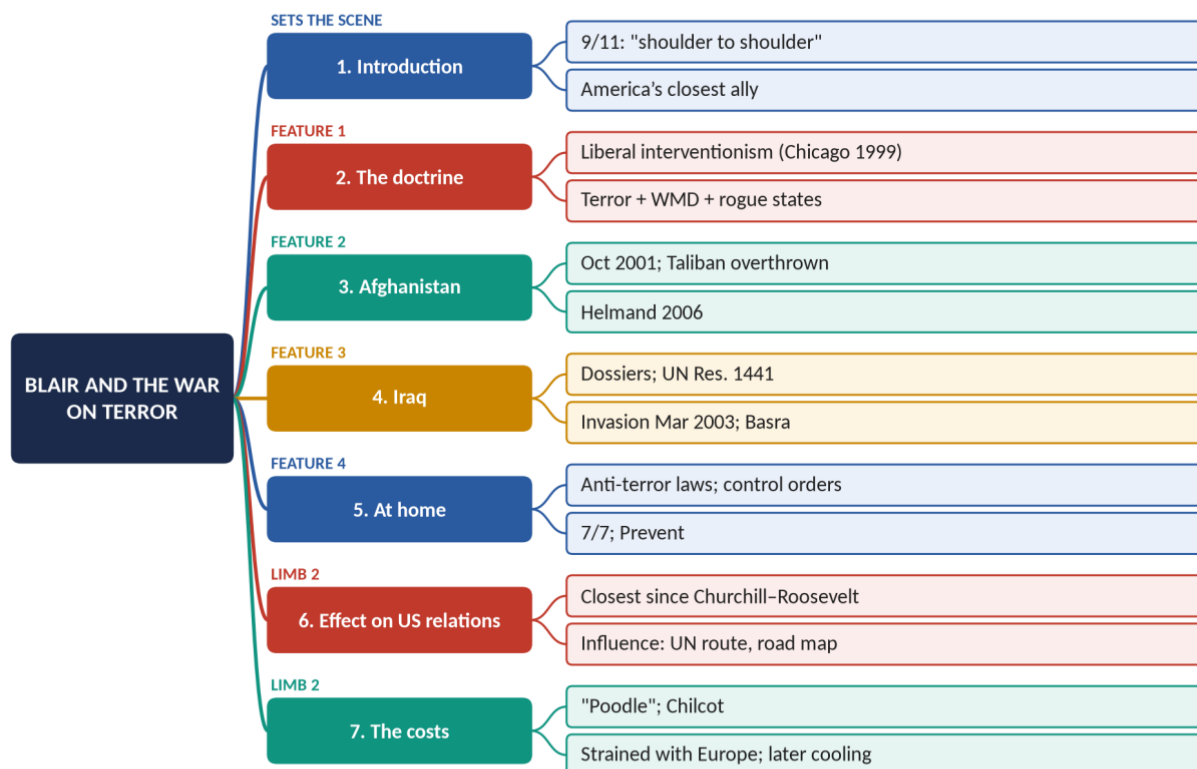
What were the salient features of Tony Blair's policy on the War on Terror? How did his policy affect US-Britain relations?

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2021 · Q8 · SECTION B (SHORT NOTE: 2026)

What were the salient features of Tony Blair's policy on the War on Terror? How did his policy affect US-Britain relations?

KEY WORDS "salient features" · "Blair's policy" · "War on Terror" · "US-Britain relations"

IT DEMANDS Two limbs: (1) the main features of Blair's approach — ideas, wars, home measures; (2) its effect on the special relationship — both closer ties and costs.



VERDICT

Blair treated the War on Terror as a moral struggle and stood beside the USA in Afghanistan and Iraq; the special relationship became closer than at any time since 1945, but at a heavy cost to his reputation and to British trust in it.

Figure 4 · The answer map for CSS 2021 · Q8 · Section B: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

Two limbs. (1) "What were the salient features of Tony Blair's policy on the War on Terror?" — the main characteristics: his **ideas** (why he fought), the **wars** (Afghanistan, Iraq), the **home** measures, and his **diplomacy**. (2) "How did his policy affect US-Britain relations?" — both the **strengthening** of the relationship and its **costs**.

The model answer

Introduction

After the terrorist attacks of **11 September 2001**, **Tony Blair** became the most important ally of **President George W. Bush** in the "War on Terror". His policy had clear features: a **moral** view of the struggle, **military intervention** in **Afghanistan** and **Iraq**, tough **security laws** at home, and an effort to **influence** America from the inside. It made the **US–British relationship** closer than at any time since the Second World War — but it left Blair branded "**Bush's poodle**", damaged Britain's relations with Europe, and after **Iraq** made the British public and Parliament wary of following the USA into war.

BRITAIN AND THE "WAR ON TERROR"

Afghanistan, Iraq and the home front

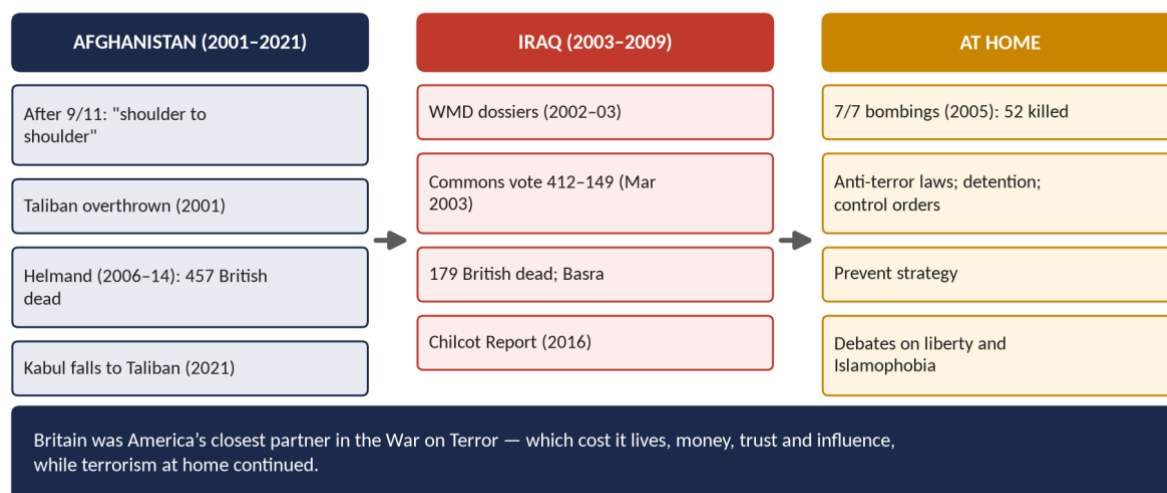


Figure 5 · Britain and the War on Terror.

Limb 1 · The salient features of Blair's policy

(1) Solidarity with America

On 9/11 Blair declared that Britain would stand "**shoulder to shoulder**" with the USA. He flew to Washington, sat in the gallery for Bush's speech to Congress, and travelled the world building support for the campaign.

(2) A moral, interventionist doctrine

- Blair saw terrorism, **rogue states** and **weapons of mass destruction** as a single new threat that justified **pre-emptive** action.
- It built on his **Chicago speech (1999)**: the "**doctrine of the international community**" — intervening to stop evil (Kosovo, Sierra Leone).
- He spoke of a struggle between values — freedom and democracy against extremism.

(3) Afghanistan (2001–)

- British forces joined the US attack (**October 2001**) that overthrew the **Taliban**, who sheltered **al-Qaeda**.
- Britain led the first **ISAF** force in Kabul and from **2006** took over **Helmand** province; **457** British service personnel died by 2014.

(4) Iraq (2003)

- Blair argued that **Saddam Hussein's WMD** threatened the world: the **September Dossier (2002)** ("45 minutes") and the "**dodgy dossier**" (2003).
- He persuaded Bush to seek **UN Resolution 1441 (November 2002)**, but failed to obtain a second resolution.
- He won a **Commons vote (18 March 2003)**; 412 to 149, with **139 Labour rebels**; **Robin Cook** resigned.
- About **46,000** British troops joined the invasion (**20 March 2003**); Britain controlled **Basra** until **2009**; **179** British deaths. **No WMD** were found.

(5) Security measures at home

- The **Anti-terrorism, Crime and Security Act (2001)**: detention without trial of foreign suspects (Belmarsh).
- **Control orders (2005)**; the attempt at **90-day** detention (defeated **2005**).
- After **7/7 (2005)**, new laws against glorifying terrorism; the **Prevent** strategy.

(6) Diplomacy and "hearts and minds"

- Blair pressed Bush to launch the **Middle East "road map" (2003)** for Israel and Palestine.
- He tried to act as a **bridge** between the USA and Europe.

Limb 2 · The effect on US–British relations

(7) A closer relationship

1. **Personal closeness**: Blair and Bush met and spoke constantly — the closest partnership since Churchill and Roosevelt.
2. **Military and intelligence integration**: British forces fought beside American forces for a decade; intelligence sharing deepened.

3. **American gratitude:** Blair was awarded the **Congressional Gold Medal** (2003) and hugely admired in the USA.

(8) British influence — real but limited

- Blair persuaded Bush to go to the **UN** first (1441) and to issue the Middle East **road map**.
- But he failed to secure a second UN resolution, a plan for post-war Iraq, or real movement on Palestine. The **Chilcot Report (2016)** found he had overestimated his ability to influence US decisions; his note of **July 2002**, "**I will be with you, whatever**", suggested unconditional support.

(9) The costs for Britain

1. **"Poodle":** Blair was widely seen as following Bush uncritically.
2. **Europe split:** France and Germany opposed the war; the "bridge" collapsed.
3. **Public trust:** the WMD failure and the death of **Dr David Kelly** (2003) damaged trust in government and in the "special relationship".
4. **Terrorism at home:** the 7/7 bombers cited Iraq and Afghanistan.

(10) Long-term effects

- **Brown** was more reserved with Bush; **Obama** spoke of an "essential relationship".
- **The "Iraq syndrome":** in **August 2013** the Commons refused to join US strikes on **Syria** — a sign that Britain would no longer automatically follow America.

VERDICT · Conclusion

Blair's War on Terror policy was marked by total solidarity with America, a moral belief in intervention, wars in Afghanistan and Iraq, tough security laws, and efforts to influence the USA from within. It made the Anglo-American relationship closer than at any time since 1945 and gave Britain a voice in Washington. But Iraq — fought on false claims and without a plan — made Blair look like America's poodle, split Britain from Europe, and left a lasting reluctance in Britain to follow the USA into war.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

Limb 1 gives **six salient features** (ideas, two wars, home laws, diplomacy) with dates and figures · **Limb 2** covers the **closer relationship**, the **limits of influence** (Chilcot), the **costs** and the **long-term** effects · a balanced verdict.

Answer 4 · "Smoke Them Out of Their Holes": A Balanced Critique of the War on Terror

THE QUESTION · CSS 2023 · Q7 · Section B · 20 marks

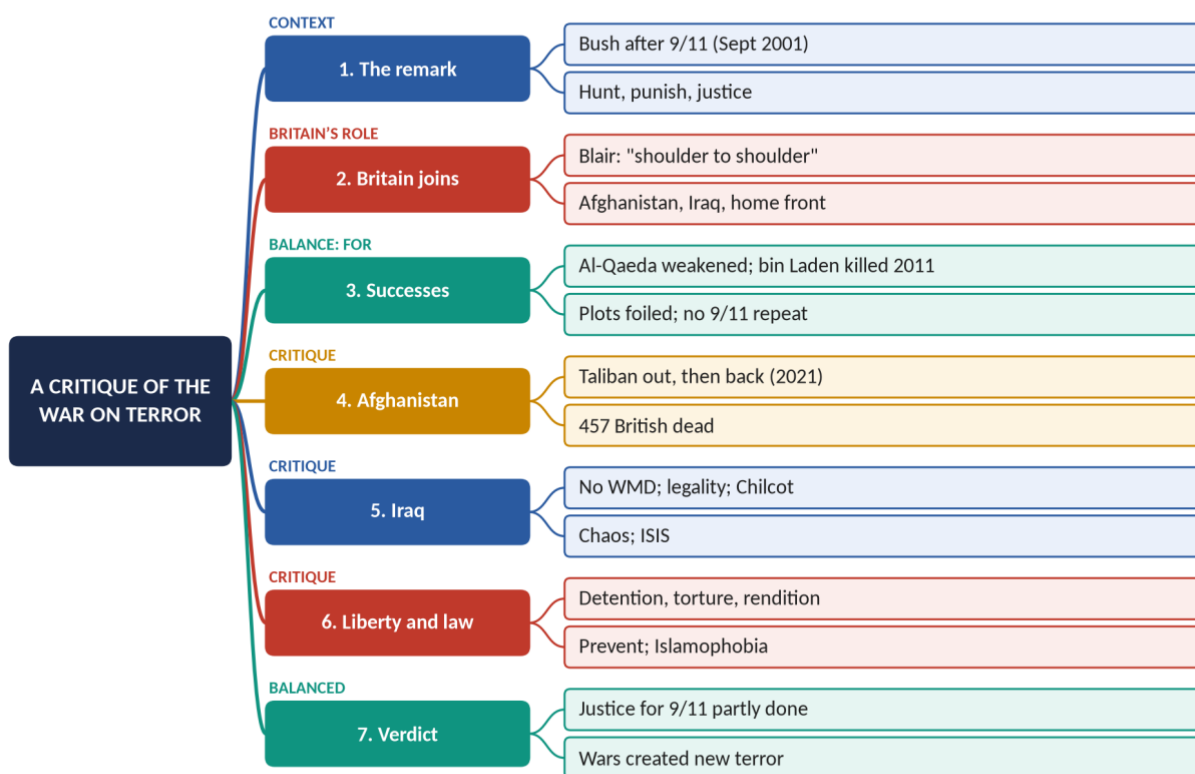
'We will find those who did it, we will smoke them out of their holes, we will get them running and we will bring them to justice.' In the context of this remark, present a balanced critique of the War on Terror with special emphasis on the role of Great Britain.

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2023 · Q7 · SECTION B

'We will find those who did it, we will smoke them out of their holes, we will get them running and we will bring them to justice.' In the context of this remark, present a balanced critique of the War on Terror with special emphasis on the role of Great Britain.

KEY WORDS "smoke them out" · "balanced critique" · "War on Terror" · "role of Great Britain"

IT DEMANDS Explain the remark (Bush, September 2001); then a balanced critique — successes and failures — with Britain's role at the centre.



VERDICT

The War on Terror brought some of the 9/11 plotters to justice and prevented many attacks, but its wars — above all Iraq, in which Britain was the chief partner — cost hundreds of thousands of lives and fuelled new terrorism.

Figure 6 · The answer map for CSS 2023 · Q7 · Section B: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

The quotation is **President George W. Bush**, speaking days after **9/11** (September 2001). "**In the context of this remark, present a balanced critique of the War on Terror with special emphasis on the role of Great Britain**" — explain what the remark promised (to **hunt down** and **bring to justice** the attackers); then give a **balanced** critique — **achievements** and **failures** — with **Britain's role** at the centre.

The model answer

Introduction

Days after al-Qaeda's attacks of **11 September 2001** killed about **3,000** people, **President George W. Bush** promised: "We will **find those who did it**, we will **smoke them out of their holes**, we will get them running and we will **bring them to justice**." The words promised a focused manhunt for the terrorists. The "**War on Terror**" that followed became something much larger — two long wars, in **Afghanistan** and **Iraq**, and a global security campaign. **Britain**, under **Tony Blair**, was America's closest partner in all of it. A balanced critique shows that the campaign did bring many terrorists to justice and prevented further attacks, but that its wars — especially **Iraq** — went far beyond the original aim, caused enormous suffering, and helped create new terrorism.

BRITAIN'S WARS AND INTERVENTIONS, 1997–2026

From Kosovo and Afghanistan to Iraq, Libya and Syria

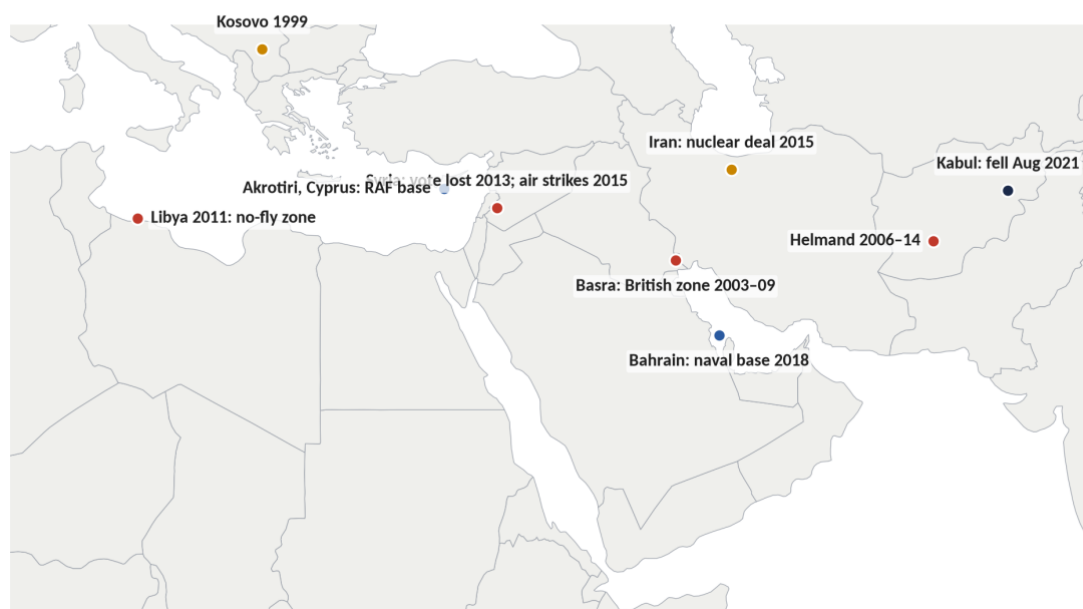


Figure 7 · Britain's wars and interventions.

The remark and the aims

(1) What Bush promised

A war of **justice** against those responsible for 9/11 — **al-Qaeda** and **Osama bin Laden** — and those who sheltered them (the **Taliban**). It was broadened within months into a war on all terrorist groups and "rogue states" with weapons of mass destruction (the "**axis of evil**", January 2002).

(2) Britain's role

Blair pledged to stand "**shoulder to shoulder**" with America; Britain joined the attack on Afghanistan (**October 2001**), the invasion of Iraq (**March 2003**), and a global campaign of intelligence and security cooperation.

Achievements

(3) "Smoking them out" — partly achieved

- **Afghanistan**: the Taliban regime was overthrown in weeks (**2001**); al-Qaeda lost its safe base.
- **Bin Laden** was found and killed by US forces in Pakistan (**May 2011**); many al-Qaeda leaders were killed or captured.
- **Plots foiled**: British and US intelligence stopped many attacks (for example the **2006** plot to blow up transatlantic airliners).
- **No repeat of 9/11** on its scale.
- **Afghan progress** (2001–21): elections, girls' education, a free press — for twenty years.

(4) Britain's contribution

Special forces, intelligence (GCHQ, MI6), Helmand's reconstruction teams, and diplomatic leadership in building the coalition.

Failures and costs

(5) Iraq — the central failure

- Iraq had **no link** to 9/11 and **no WMD** — the grounds for war were false.
- Britain's **dossiers** exaggerated the intelligence; no second **UN** resolution was obtained; many lawyers regard the war as **illegal**.
- **The Chilcot Report (2016)**: war before peaceful options were exhausted; "wholly inadequate" planning.
- **Human cost**: **179** British dead; Iraqi deaths in the **hundreds of thousands**; millions displaced; sectarian civil war.
- **Iraq created new terrorism**: al-Qaeda in Iraq, and later **ISIS (2014)**.

(6) Afghanistan — a lost war

- British forces in **Helmand (2006–14)**: **457** British deaths; limited progress against the Taliban and opium.
- **August 2021**: the **Taliban** retook Kabul within days of the US withdrawal; twenty years of effort collapsed.

(7) Justice and values

- **Guantánamo, rendition and torture** — British intelligence was complicit in some cases (the 2018 Intelligence and Security Committee reports).
- **Detention without trial** (Belmarsh, 2001–04) and **control orders** in Britain.
- **Prevent** was accused of stigmatising Muslims; Islamophobia rose.
- These undermined the very values the War on Terror claimed to defend.

(8) Terrorism at home

- **7/7 (2005)**: 52 killed by British-born bombers who cited Iraq and Afghanistan.
- Later attacks (**2017**: Westminster, Manchester Arena, London Bridge).

(9) Political costs for Britain

- Blair's reputation destroyed ("**Bush's poodle**"); public trust in government fell.
- Britain's standing in the Muslim world and in Europe damaged.
- The "**Iraq syndrome**": Parliament refused Syria strikes (2013).

Achievements	Failures
Taliban overthrown (2001); bin Laden killed (2011)	Iraq on false grounds; illegal?; Chilcot
Many plots foiled; no new 9/11	Hundreds of thousands dead; ISIS
Twenty years of Afghan progress	Taliban back (2021)
International intelligence cooperation	Torture, rendition, detention without trial
	7/7; terrorism at home; lost trust

VERDICT · Conclusion

Measured against Bush's promise, the War on Terror partly succeeded: al-Qaeda lost its Afghan base, bin Laden was killed and many plots were stopped. But the campaign went far beyond bringing the 9/11 attackers to justice. Britain's role was central — Blair was America's chief partner — and Britain shared the responsibility for its greatest failure: an invasion of Iraq on false grounds that killed hundreds of thousands, helped create ISIS and fuelled terrorism at home, while the war in Afghanistan ended in the Taliban's return. On balance, the War on Terror did more to spread the violence it aimed to end than to defeat it.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

It **explains the remark** and shows how the war went **beyond** it · the critique is genuinely **balanced** — a full section of **achievements** and of **failures** · **Britain's role** is at the centre throughout (Blair, Helmand, Basra, dossiers, Chilcot, 7/7) · a summary table and a reasoned verdict.

Answer 5 · How the Financial Crisis Plunged Britain into Recession, and How It Responded

THE QUESTION · CSS 2023 · Q8 · Section B · 20 marks

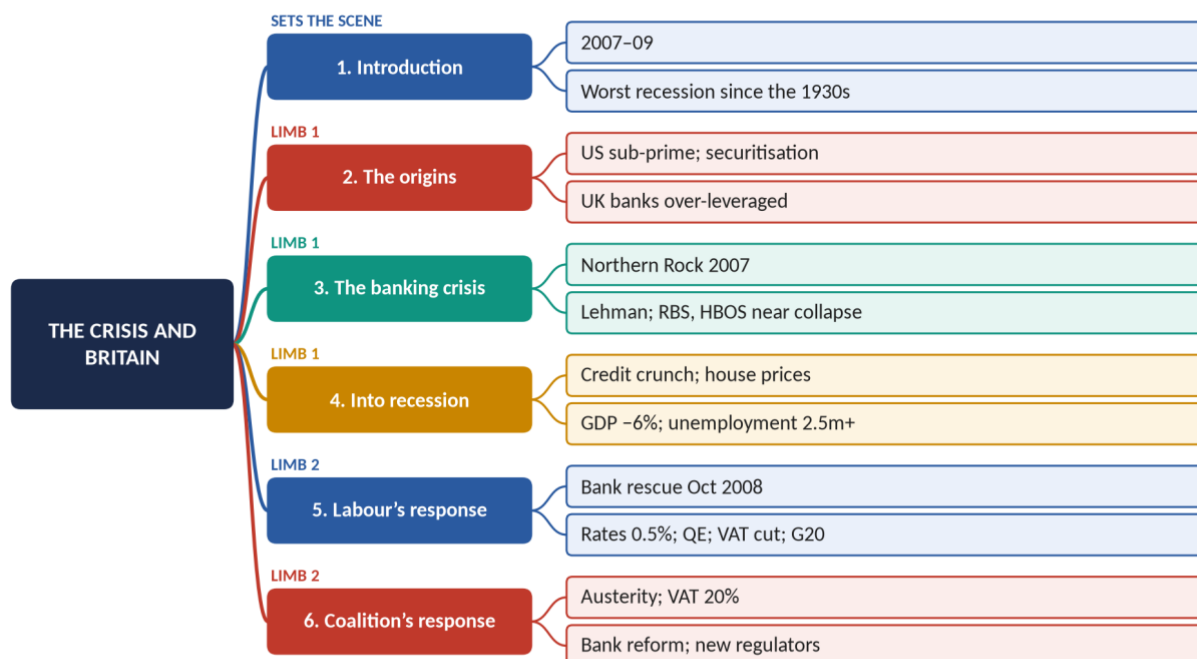
How did the global financial crisis plunge Britain into recession in the 21st century and how did it respond?

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2023 · Q8 · SECTION B

How did the global financial crisis plunge Britain into recession in the 21st century and how did it respond?

KEY WORDS "global financial crisis" · "plunge Britain into recession" · "how did it respond"

IT DEMANDS Two limbs: (1) the mechanism — how a US housing crisis became a British recession; (2) the response of government and Bank of England.



VERDICT

The global crisis reached Britain through its large, over-borrowed banks; the government rescued them and cut rates, avoiding collapse, but the recession was deep and recovery slow.

Figure 8 · The answer map for CSS 2023 · Q8 · Section B; every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

Two limbs. (1) "How did the global financial crisis plunge Britain into recession?" — explain the **chain**: from American mortgages to British banks, to the credit crunch, to falling output and jobs. (2) "... and how did it respond?" — the actions of the **government** (Labour, 2007–10, and briefly the coalition from 2010) and the **Bank of England**.

The model answer

Introduction

The **global financial crisis** of **2007–09** began in the American housing market, but it hit **Britain** with special force because Britain's economy depended so heavily on its huge, over-borrowed **banks**. As banks failed or nearly failed, lending dried up, confidence collapsed and Britain suffered its **deepest recession since the Second World War**, with output falling by about **6 per cent**. The **Labour** government of **Gordon Brown** and **Alistair Darling** responded boldly — rescuing the banks, cutting interest rates to almost zero and stimulating the economy — and led a coordinated international response; from **2010** the coalition turned to **austerity** to cut the huge deficit.

THE GLOBAL FINANCIAL CRISIS AND BRITAIN

From Northern Rock to austerity

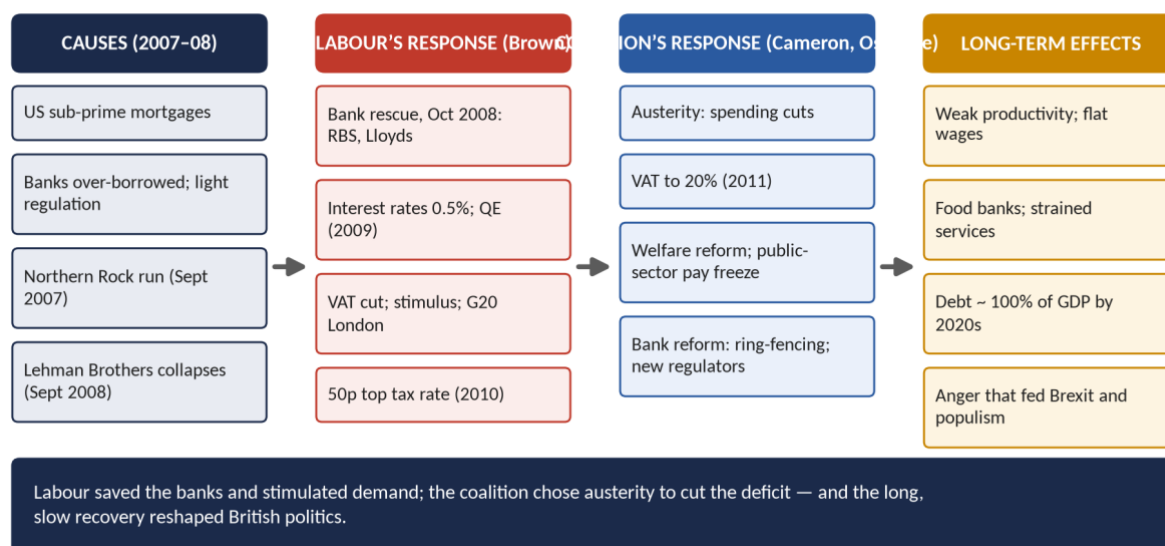


Figure 9 · The crisis and Britain.

Limb 1 · How the crisis caused recession

(1) The American origins

- US banks lent to "**sub-prime**" borrowers who could not repay; these mortgages were bundled into complex securities and sold to banks around the world.
- When US house prices fell (2006–07), the securities lost value; no one knew which banks held the bad debts.

(2) Britain's vulnerability

- British banks had grown to over **four times** the size of the economy; RBS was briefly the world's largest bank.
- They relied on short-term borrowing from the **money markets** rather than savers' deposits.

- Regulation by the **Financial Services Authority** was "light-touch".
- Households had borrowed heavily; house prices had soared.

(3) The banking crisis

- **Northern Rock (September 2007)**: unable to borrow on the markets, it asked the Bank of England for help; savers queued to withdraw their money — the first **bank run** in Britain for about 150 years. It was **nationalised (February 2008)**.
- **Lehman Brothers** collapsed (**15 September 2008**); markets froze. **HBOS** was rescued by **Lloyds**; **Bradford & Bingley** was nationalised; **RBS** was hours from collapse (October 2008).

(4) From banking crisis to recession

1. **The credit crunch**: banks stopped lending to businesses and households.
2. **Falling confidence**: businesses cut investment and jobs; consumers cut spending.
3. **House prices fell**, making people feel poorer.
4. **World trade collapsed**, hitting exports.
5. **Result: GDP fell by about 6 per cent (2008–09); unemployment** rose to about **2.5 million**; government borrowing reached about **10 per cent** of GDP.

Limb 2 · How Britain responded

(5) The bank rescue (October 2008)

On **8 October 2008** Brown and Darling announced a package of about **£500 billion** in guarantees, loans and new capital. The state took large stakes in **RBS** (eventually about **84 per cent**) and **Lloyds** (about **43 per cent**). Other countries copied the British model.

(6) Monetary policy

- The **Bank of England** cut **Bank Rate** from 5 per cent to **0.5 per cent (March 2009)** — the lowest in its history.
- **Quantitative easing** (from **March 2009**): the Bank created money to buy government bonds — **£375 billion** by 2012.

(7) Fiscal stimulus

- **VAT** cut from 17.5 to **15 per cent (December 2008 – January 2010)**.
- Public spending maintained; a car scrappage scheme; help for homeowners and the unemployed.
- A new **50p** top rate of income tax (**2010**).

(8) International leadership

Brown hosted the **G20** summit in **London (April 2009)**, which agreed about **\$1 trillion** for the IMF and world economy — widely credited with preventing a second Great Depression.

(9) The coalition's response (from 2010)

- **Austerity:** **George Osborne** set out to eliminate the deficit through spending cuts (about 80 per cent) and tax rises (VAT to **20 per cent**, 2011).
- **Banking reform:** the **Vickers** report (2011) — **ring-fencing** of retail banking; the FSA replaced by the **Prudential Regulation Authority** and **Financial Conduct Authority** (**2013**).

(10) Results

- The banking system was saved; the recession ended in **2009**; but the **recovery** was the slowest for a century, with stagnant wages and weak productivity.

VERDICT · Conclusion

The global financial crisis plunged Britain into recession because its enormous, over-borrowed banks were exposed to American bad debts: when they failed, credit dried up, confidence collapsed and output fell by about 6 per cent. Britain's response — the bank rescue, near-zero interest rates, quantitative easing and a fiscal stimulus under Labour, followed by austerity and banking reform under the coalition — prevented a financial collapse, but could not prevent a long and painful recovery.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

Limb 1 shows the **chain of causation** step by step (US mortgages → British banks → credit crunch → recession) · Limb 2 covers **government, Bank of England and international** responses with **figures and dates**, and the coalition's turn to austerity · a clear verdict.

Answer 6 · The Financial Crisis: Impact, Two Responses and Long-Term Effects

THE QUESTION · CSS 2025 · Q7 · Section B · 20 marks

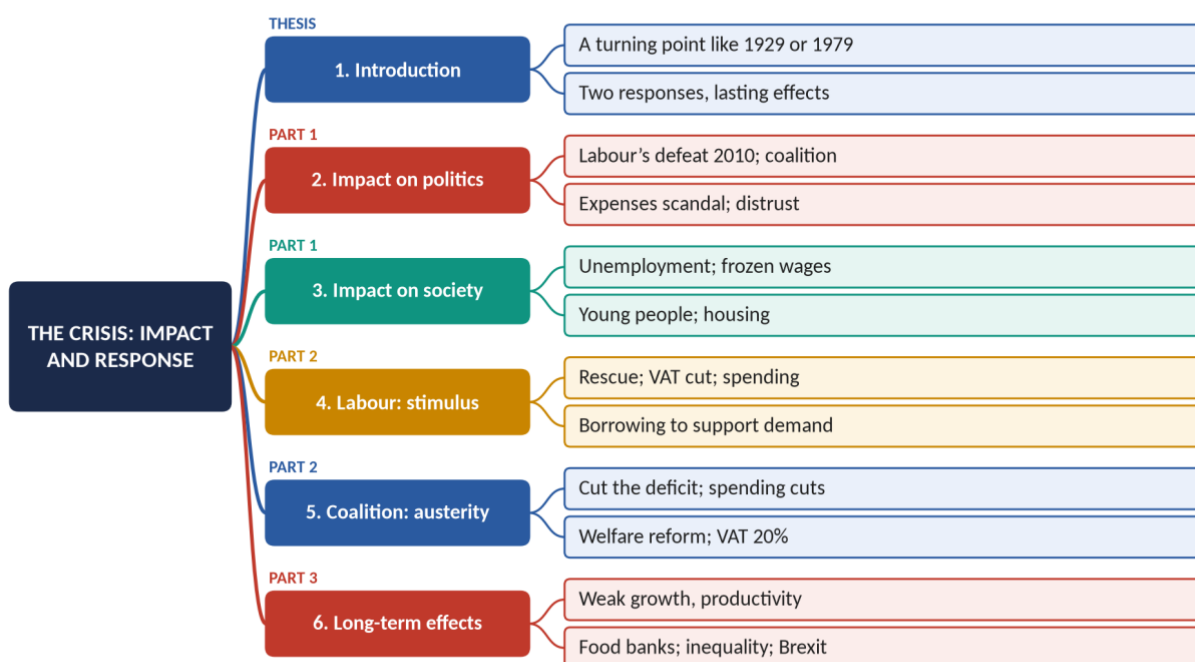
**How did the global financial crisis of 2008 impact British politics and society?
How did the responses of the Labour and Conservative governments differ, and
what were their long-term effects?**

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2025 · Q7 · SECTION B

How did the global financial crisis of 2008 impact British politics and society? How did the responses of the Labour and Conservative governments differ, and what were their long-term effects?

KEY WORDS “impact” · “politics and society” · “responses ... differ” · “long-term effects”

IT DEMANDS Three parts: the impact (politics, society); a comparison of the Labour (2008–10) and Conservative-led (2010–) responses; their long-term effects.



VERDICT

The crisis ended Labour's rule, produced a coalition and a decade of austerity, and left weak growth, stagnant wages and public anger that reshaped British politics — above all in the Brexit vote.

Figure 10 · The answer map for CSS 2025 · Q7 · Section B: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

Three parts. (1) "How did the global financial crisis of 2008 impact British politics and society?" (2) "How did the responses of the Labour and Conservative governments differ?" — **Labour** (Brown, 2008–10) v the **Conservative-led** coalition and Conservative governments (from 2010). (3) "... and what were their long-term effects?" — the lasting consequences of both responses.

The model answer

Introduction

The financial crisis of **2008** was a turning point in modern British history, comparable to **1929** or **1979**. It ended the long boom of the New Labour years, brought down the Labour government, and produced the first coalition since 1945. Labour responded with **Keynesian stimulus** — rescuing the banks and supporting demand; the Conservative-led coalition chose **austerity** — cutting spending to reduce the deficit. The long-term effects — weak growth, stagnant wages, strained public services and deep public anger — reshaped British politics, and helped lead to **Brexit**.

Part 1 · The impact on politics and society

(1) Politics

1. **The fall of Labour:** the crisis destroyed Labour's claim to economic competence ("no return to boom and bust"); at the **2010** election Labour lost 91 seats.
2. **A hung parliament and coalition:** the Conservatives and **Liberal Democrats** formed the first peacetime coalition since the 1930s.
3. **Distrust of elites:** the **MPs' expenses scandal (2009)** and anger at bankers' bonuses deepened contempt for politicians and the City.
4. **Protest:** the student protests over tuition fees (**2010**); **Occupy London (2011)**; the **August 2011 riots**.
5. **New politics:** the rise of **UKIP**, the **SNP** and, in Labour, **Jeremy Corbyn (2015)** — all feeding on anti-establishment anger.

(2) Society

1. **Unemployment** rose to about **2.5–2.7 million**; youth unemployment passed **1 million** (2011).
2. **Wages:** real wages fell and did not return to their 2008 level for over a decade — the longest squeeze since the Napoleonic Wars.
3. **Housing:** young people were priced out; home ownership among the young fell.
4. **Poverty:** food-bank use soared (the **Trussell Trust**: from about 26,000 people in 2008–09 to over **1 million** by 2014–15).

5. Inequality between regions and generations widened.

Part 2 · How the two responses differed

THE GLOBAL FINANCIAL CRISIS AND BRITAIN

From Northern Rock to austerity

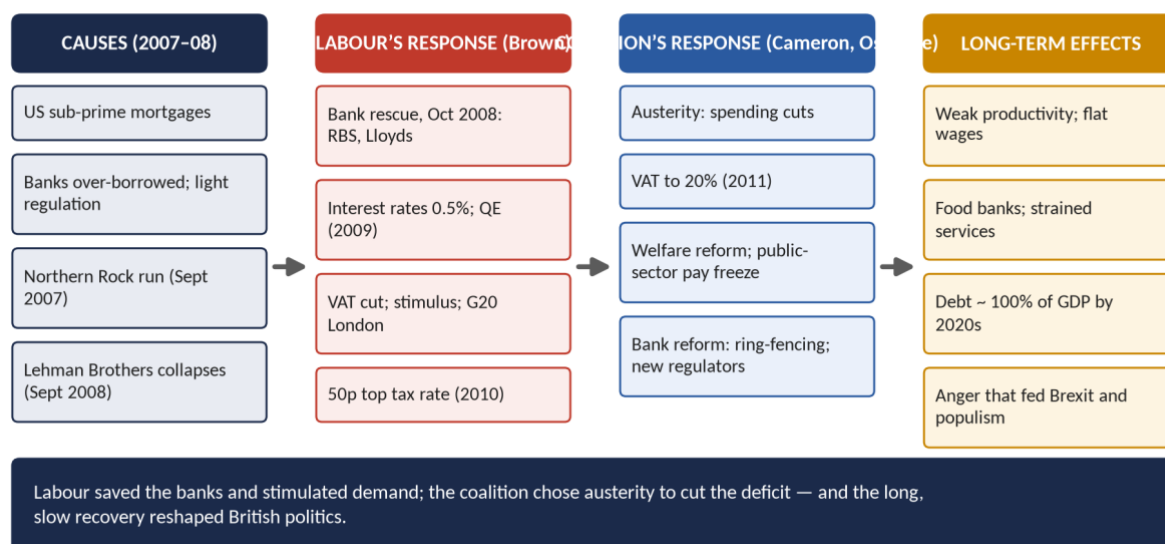


Figure 11 · Two responses to the crisis.

(3) Labour's response (2008–2010): stimulus

- **Philosophy: Keynesian** — in a slump, government should borrow and spend to support demand.
- **The bank rescue (October 2008)**: about £500 billion; part-nationalisation of **RBS** and **Lloyds**.
- **Stimulus**: VAT cut to 15 per cent; spending maintained; job schemes; car scrappage.
- **Monetary support**: Bank Rate at **0.5 per cent**; **quantitative easing** (from 2009).
- **Taxes on the rich**: a **50p** income-tax rate; a bonus tax on bankers.
- **International**: the **G20 London** summit (2009).

(4) The Conservative-led response (2010–2016): austerity

- **Philosophy: fiscal consolidation** — the deficit (about 10 per cent of GDP) threatened confidence; the state must shrink. **"We're all in this together"** (Osborne).
- **Spending cuts**: about a fifth of departmental budgets; local government cut by about **40 per cent**; public-sector pay frozen.
- **Welfare reform**: benefit freezes; the benefit cap; **Universal Credit**.
- **Taxes**: VAT raised to **20 per cent** (2011); the top rate cut to **45p** (2013); the tax-free allowance raised.
- **Bank reform**: ring-fencing; new regulators (**PRA** and **FCA**, 2013).
- **Monetary policy** continued: near-zero rates and more QE.

	Labour (2008–10)	Conservative-led (2010–16)
Aim	Protect jobs and output	Cut the deficit
Spending	Maintained	Cut sharply
Tax	VAT cut; 50p rate	VAT 20%; top rate 45p
Banks	Rescue	Reform
Welfare	Protected	Cut and restructured

Part 3 · The long-term effects

(5) Of Labour's response

- The **rescue** prevented a banking collapse and a depression; the taxpayer eventually sold most bank shares (Lloyds fully returned to private hands in **2017**; NatWest/RBS in **2025**), though at a loss on RBS.
- **QE** and low rates kept the economy afloat but **inflated asset prices** — benefiting homeowners and the wealthy more than the young and poor.
- **Debt** rose sharply.

(6) Of austerity

1. **Slow recovery**: growth and **productivity** well below the pre-2008 trend — the "productivity puzzle".
2. **Weaker public services**: the NHS, social care, councils, prisons and courts under strain.
3. **Poverty and inequality**: food banks; child poverty rose again after 2012.
4. **The deficit** was cut, but debt stayed high (near **100 per cent** of GDP after Covid).
5. **Brexit**: research (e.g. **Thiemo Fetzer**, 2019) found that austerity cuts increased the **Leave** vote, especially in poorer areas.

(7) For British politics

- The end of the post-1997 consensus; the rise of **populism** on left and right.
- A lasting debate between **austerity** and **investment** — revived after Truss's mini-budget (2022) and in the Labour governments of Starmer (2024–26) and Burnham (from 2026).

VERDICT · Conclusion

The 2008 crisis ended Labour's rule, created a coalition, deepened distrust of politicians and bankers, and left millions poorer. Labour responded with a Keynesian rescue and stimulus that prevented collapse; the Conservative-led coalition chose austerity to cut the deficit. Together these responses saved the banks but produced a decade of weak growth, stagnant wages and strained services — the soil in which anti-establishment politics, and the vote for Brexit, grew.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

All three parts addressed separately · the **impact** is split into **politics** and **society** · the **two responses** are compared point by point in a **table** · the **long-term effects** of **each** response are traced to the present (Brexit, populism, debt) · a strong conclusion.

Answer 7 · David Cameron's Foreign Policy, with Special Reference to the Middle East

THE QUESTION · CSS 2016 · Q7 · Section B · 20 marks

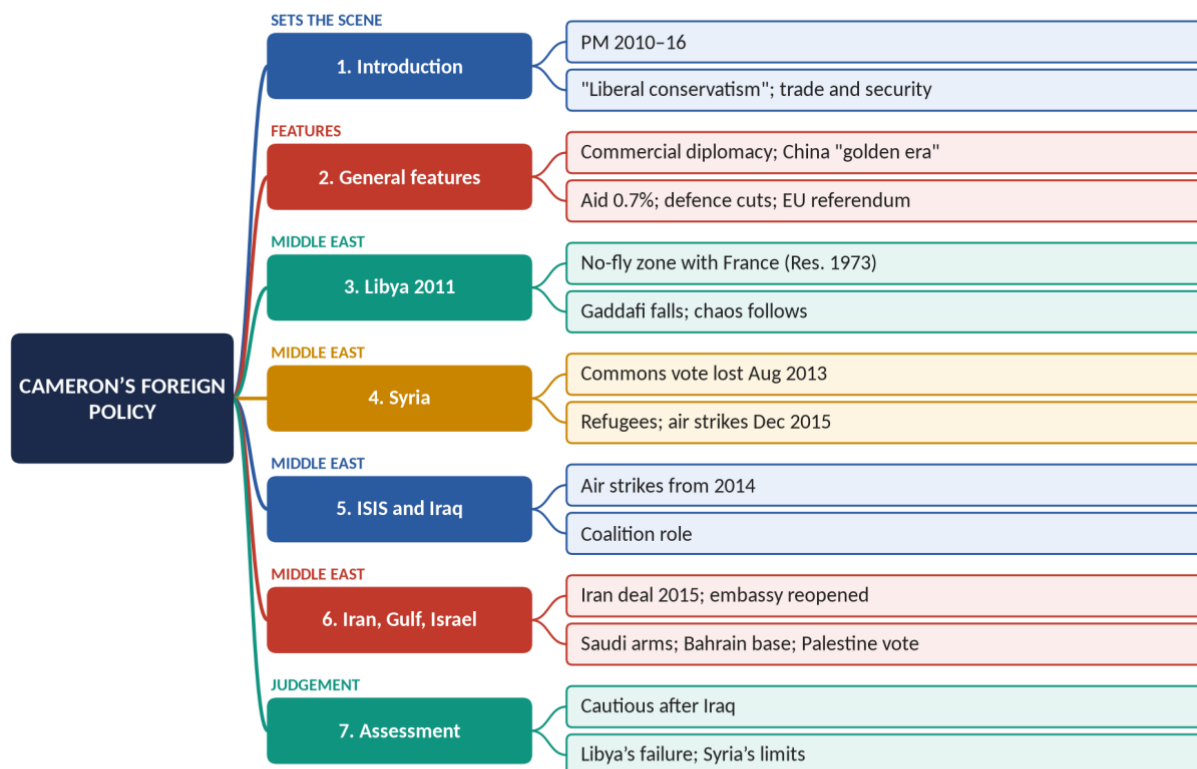
Discuss the main features of the foreign policy of David Cameron with special reference to the Middle East.

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2016 · Q7 · SECTION B

Discuss the main features of the foreign policy of David Cameron with special reference to the Middle East.

KEY WORDS "main features" · "foreign policy" · "David Cameron" · "special reference to the Middle East"

IT DEMANDS Briefly the general features, then the Middle East in depth: Libya, Syria, ISIS, Iran, Israel–Palestine, the Gulf, Afghanistan.



VERDICT

Cameron's foreign policy combined trade and aid with cautious "liberal conservatism"; in the Middle East he led the Libyan intervention, was blocked by Parliament over Syria, fought ISIS and backed the Iran deal — with mixed results.

Figure 12 · The answer map for CSS 2016 · Q7 · Section B: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

"Discuss the main features of the foreign policy of David Cameron" — his general approach and priorities (2010–16). "With special reference to the Middle East" — most of the answer must be on the region: the **Arab Spring**, **Libya**, **Syria**, **ISIS**, **Iran**, the **Gulf**, **Israel–Palestine** and **Afghanistan**. End with an assessment.

The model answer

Introduction

David Cameron was Prime Minister from **2010 to 2016**, first in coalition with the Liberal Democrats and then with a Conservative majority. His foreign policy was shaped by the lessons of **Iraq** and by the **financial crisis**: he called himself a "**liberal conservative**" — committed to freedom and democracy, but "not a naive neo-conservative". Its main features were **commercial diplomacy**, a large **aid** budget, **cuts** in defence, a **cautious** approach to military intervention, and, at the end, the **EU referendum**. In the **Middle East** he led the intervention in **Libya** (2011), was defeated by Parliament over **Syria** (2013), joined the campaign against **ISIS**, supported the **Iran** nuclear deal and kept close ties with the **Gulf** — with very mixed results.

General features

(1) "Liberal conservatism"

Support for democracy and human rights, but realism about what force could achieve: "we cannot drop democracy from 40,000 feet".

(2) Commercial diplomacy

Foreign policy was to serve **trade and growth**: many trade missions; the "**golden era**" with **China** (Xi Jinping's state visit, **October 2015**); arms and trade deals with the Gulf and India.

(3) Aid and soft power

Aid at **0.7 per cent** of national income, made law in **2015** — Britain became a development "superpower".

(4) Defence cuts and the "Iraq syndrome"

The **2010 Strategic Defence and Security Review** cut the army and scrapped the Harrier carriers; later a pledge to spend **2 per cent** of GDP on defence (NATO, 2015).

(5) Europe and Russia

The **Bloomberg speech** (2013), renegotiation and the **2016 referendum**; sanctions on **Russia** after the annexation of **Crimea** (2014).

The Middle East

BRITAIN'S WARS AND INTERVENTIONS, 1997–2026

From Kosovo and Afghanistan to Iraq, Libya and Syria

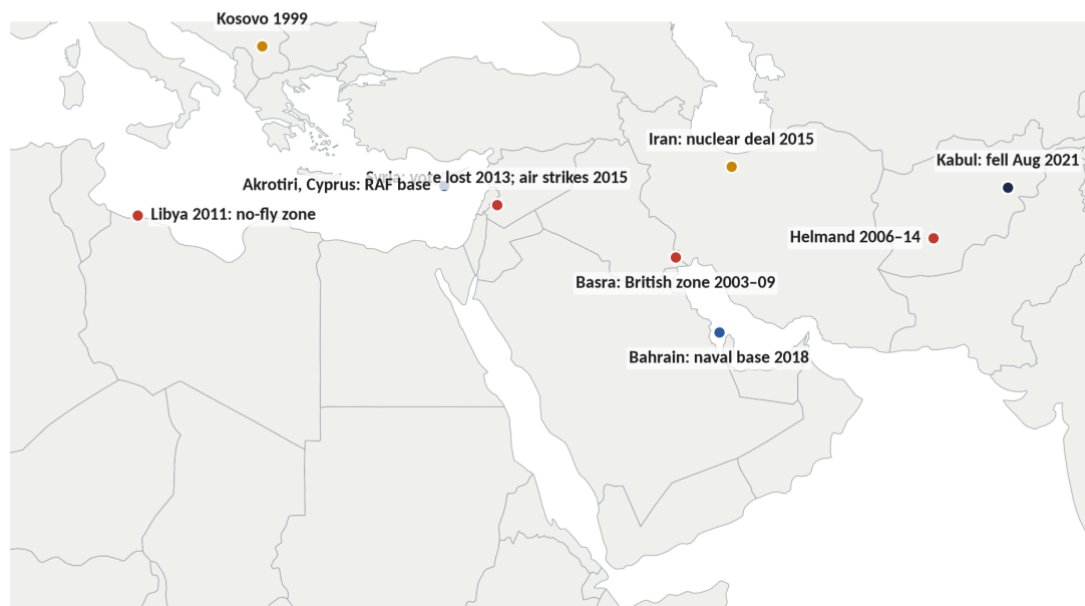


Figure 13 · Britain in the Middle East.

(6) The Arab Spring (2011)

Cameron welcomed the uprisings in Tunisia and Egypt as a chance for democracy — though Britain had long supported the region's authoritarian rulers — and was the first Western leader to visit Cairo after Mubarak fell.

(7) Libya (2011) — his defining intervention

- When **Colonel Gaddafi** threatened to massacre rebels in **Benghazi**, Cameron and France's **Nicolas Sarkozy** pushed for **UN Security Council Resolution 1973 (March 2011)**, authorising a **no-fly zone** and "all necessary measures" to protect civilians.
- British and French aircraft, with US support, destroyed Gaddafi's forces; the rebels took Tripoli; **Gaddafi was killed (October 2011)**.
- **But** Libya collapsed into civil war, militias and people-smuggling; ISIS gained a foothold. The **Commons Foreign Affairs Committee (2016)** concluded that the intervention was based on poor intelligence and had no plan for the aftermath; President **Obama** called the aftermath a "**mess**" (2016).

(8) Syria

- Cameron demanded that **President Assad** step down and supported the moderate opposition.
- After a chemical attack near Damascus (**Ghouta, August 2013**), he sought approval for strikes, but the **House of Commons voted against (29 August 2013, 285 to 272)** —

the first defeat of a Prime Minister on a question of war since 1782. It showed the power of the "**Iraq syndrome**" and led the USA to step back too.

- **Refugees:** Britain gave large humanitarian aid and pledged to resettle **20,000** Syrian refugees (**2015**).

(9) ISIS

- After **ISIS** seized much of Iraq and Syria (**2014**), British aircraft joined the US-led coalition: strikes in **Iraq** (from **September 2014**) and, after a Commons vote, **Syria** (**December 2015**).

(10) Iran

Britain was one of the "P5+1" powers that negotiated the **Iran nuclear deal (JCPOA, July 2015)**; the British **embassy in Tehran** reopened (**August 2015**).

(11) The Gulf

- Close relations with **Saudi Arabia** and the Gulf states: large **arms sales**, criticised during the Saudi-led war in **Yemen** (from **2015**).
- A permanent **naval base** in **Bahrain** (agreed **2014**) — a symbolic return "east of Suez".

(12) Israel and Palestine

Support for a **two-state solution**; Cameron called Gaza "a prison camp" (**2010**); in **2014** the Commons voted (non-bindingly) to recognise Palestine; the government did not act on it.

(13) Afghanistan

British **combat operations ended** in **October 2014** (Camp Bastion handed over).

Assessment

Successes	Failures
Prevented a massacre in Benghazi (2011)	Libya's collapse; no post-war plan
Iran nuclear deal (2015)	Syria: vote lost; Assad survived; civil war raged
Contribution against ISIS	Arms sales and Yemen
Aid and refugees	Arab Spring hopes mostly failed
Ended Afghan combat role	Declining influence; EU referendum weakened Britain

VERDICT · Conclusion

Cameron's foreign policy combined commercial diplomacy, generous aid and a cautious "liberal conservatism" shaped by the memory of Iraq. In the Middle East he acted boldly in Libya — preventing a massacre but leaving chaos — was stopped by Parliament over Syria, joined the fight against ISIS, backed the Iran nuclear deal and kept close ties with the Gulf. His record there was mixed: humanitarian aims were often undermined by the absence of long-term plans, and Britain's influence in the region declined.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

The **general features** are covered briefly, with **most space on the Middle East** as required · each country or issue has its **own section** with **dates, UN resolutions and votes** · critical sources (**Foreign Affairs Committee, Obama**) · an **assessment table**.

Answer 8 · The Advantages and Disadvantages of Brexit for England

THE QUESTION · CSS 2017 · Q8 · Section B · 20 marks

What are the advantages and disadvantages of Brexit for England? Analyse with arguments.

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2017 · Q8 · SECTION B

What are the advantages and disadvantages of Brexit for England? Analyse with arguments.

KEY WORDS “advantages” · “disadvantages” · “Brexit” · “Analyse with arguments”

IT DEMANDS Both sides, grouped by area (sovereignty, economy, migration, trade, the Union, influence), then a reasoned judgement — using evidence since 2020.

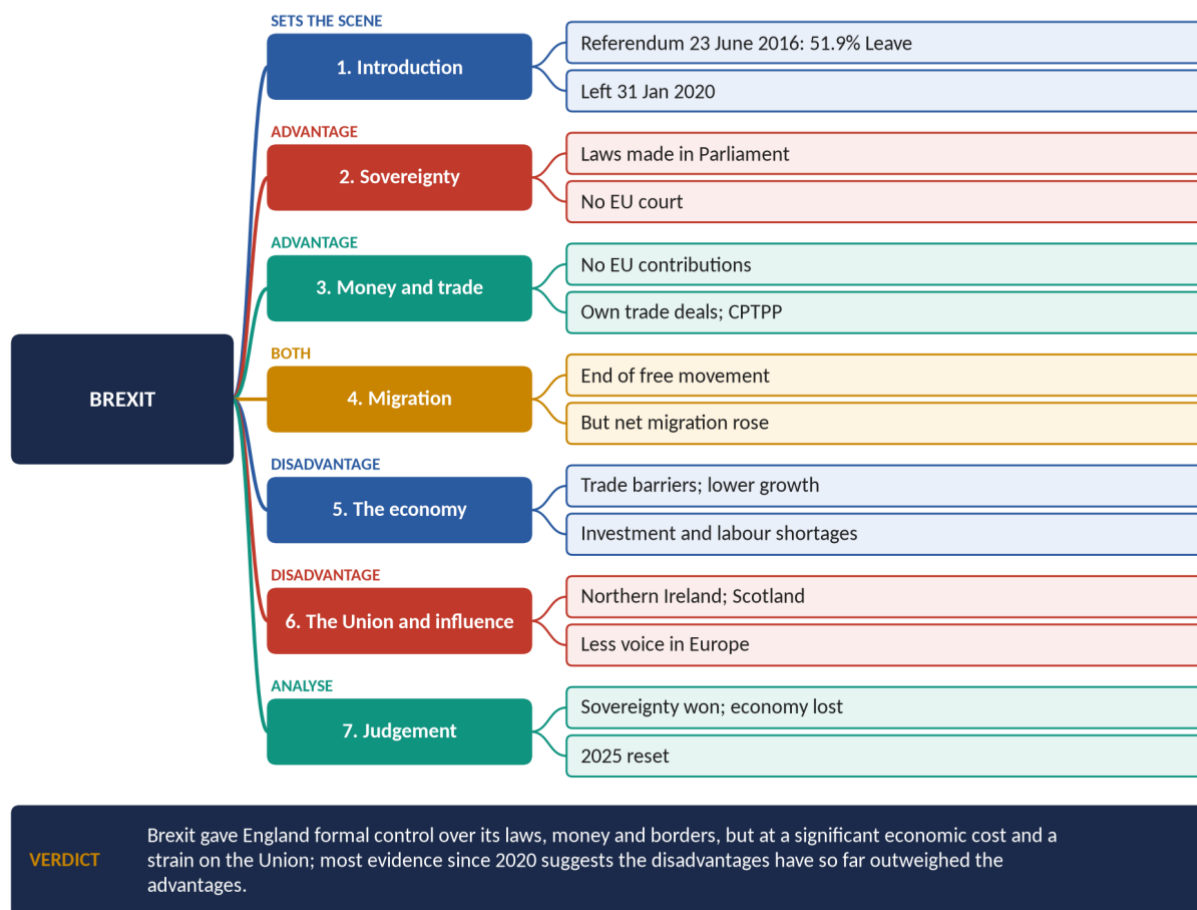


Figure 14 · The answer map for CSS 2017 · Q8 · Section B: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

"What are the advantages and disadvantages of Brexit for England? Analyse with arguments." Set out **both sides**, grouped by area (sovereignty, money, trade, the economy, immigration, the Union, influence), weigh them with **evidence**, and give your own reasoned judgement. The question was set in **2017**; today you can also use the **evidence since 2020**. "England" here means the United Kingdom — but note the different effects on Scotland and Northern Ireland.

The model answer

Introduction

On **23 June 2016** the United Kingdom voted by **51.9 per cent** to **48.1 per cent** to leave the **European Union** — "**Brexit**". England (53 per cent Leave) and Wales voted to leave; Scotland and Northern Ireland voted to remain. After years of deadlock Britain left on **31 January 2020**. Supporters promised to "**Take Back Control**" of laws, money and borders; opponents warned of economic damage and a weaker Union. This answer argues that Brexit brought real gains in **formal sovereignty** and **policy freedom**, but that the evidence so far shows significant **economic costs** and strains on the **Union** — so that, on balance, the disadvantages have outweighed the advantages.

BREXIT: ADVANTAGES AND DISADVANTAGES

The arguments of 2016 and the evidence since 2020

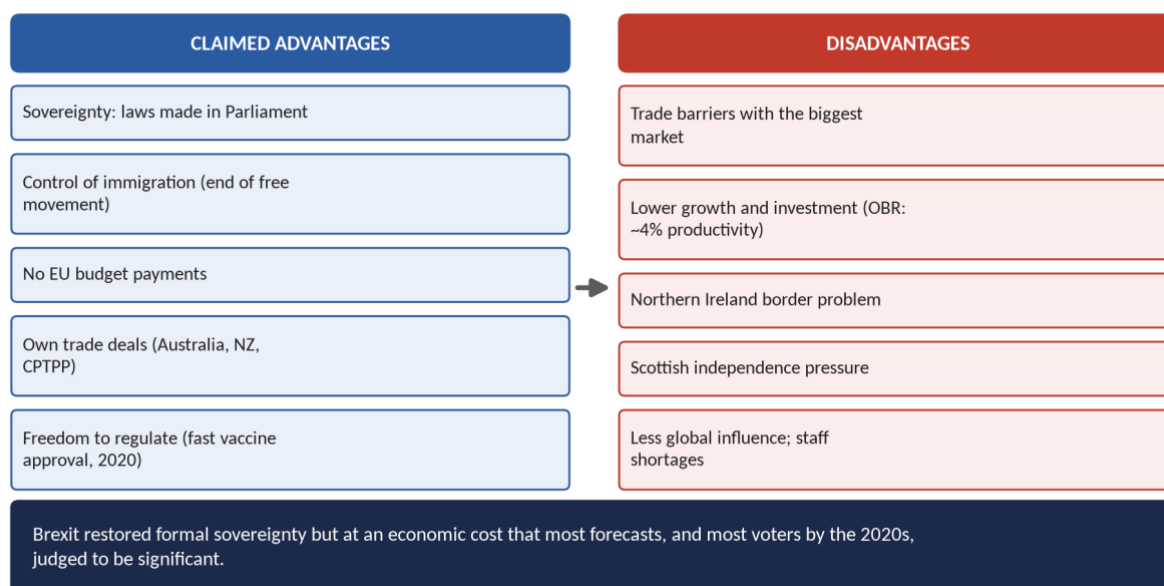


Figure 15 · Brexit: advantages and disadvantages.

The advantages

(1) Sovereignty and democracy

- Laws are now made by the **UK Parliament**, and the **European Court of Justice** no longer has authority over British law (except in parts of the Northern Ireland arrangements).
- For many voters this was the heart of the matter: accountability to British voters rather than Brussels.

(2) Money

Britain no longer pays an annual **net contribution** to the EU budget (about **£9–10 billion** a year before Brexit).

(3) Trade policy

Britain can make its own trade agreements: with **Australia** and **New Zealand** (2021–23), membership of the **CPTPP** (the Pacific trade bloc, 2024–25), a deal with **India** (2025), and a tariff deal with the **USA** (2025).

(4) Regulatory freedom

- Britain can set its own rules. The **Covid vaccine** was approved first in the world (**December 2020**).
- Freedom to design rules for new technology (AI, gene editing), financial services and state aid.

(5) Immigration

Free movement from the EU ended; a **points-based** immigration system (2021) gives the government control over who comes.

(6) Agriculture and fishing

Britain left the Common Agricultural Policy and Common Fisheries Policy and can design its own farm subsidies (paying for environmental "public goods").

The disadvantages

(7) Trade with Europe

- The EU is Britain's largest market (about **40 per cent** of exports). The **Trade and Cooperation Agreement** (2020) avoided tariffs, but introduced customs checks, rules-of-origin paperwork and regulatory barriers.
- The **Office for Budget Responsibility** estimates that trade will be about **15 per cent** lower in the long run than if Britain had stayed.

(8) The economy

- The OBR estimates long-run **productivity** about **4 per cent** lower; business **investment** stagnated after 2016.
- Small firms found exporting to the EU harder; some moved operations abroad.
- The **City** lost its "passporting" rights; some jobs moved to Dublin, Paris, Frankfurt and Amsterdam.

(9) Immigration — an unexpected result

- EU migration fell, but **labour shortages** appeared (lorry drivers, care workers, hospitality, farming).
- **Net migration** actually rose to record levels (about **900,000** in 2022–23), mainly from outside the EU — so the promise of lower immigration was not met.

(10) The Union

- **Northern Ireland**: avoiding a hard border with the Irish Republic required a customs border in the Irish Sea (the **Protocol**, later the **Windsor Framework**, 2023) — angering unionists; power-sharing collapsed (2022–24).
- **Scotland**: having voted 62 per cent to remain, it saw renewed demands for **independence**.

(11) Influence and other losses

- Britain lost its voice in EU decisions and its role as America's "bridge" to Europe.
- It left the **Erasmus** student exchange (replaced by the Turing scheme) and was out of the **Horizon** science programme until **2024**.
- Travel and work in the EU became harder for British citizens.

Analysis

Area	Advantage	Disadvantage
Sovereignty	Parliament supreme; no ECJ	Must follow EU rules to trade, with no say
Money	No EU contribution	Lower growth reduces tax revenue far more
Trade	New deals (CPTPP, India)	EU trade barriers outweigh new deals
Economy	Regulatory freedom	Productivity –4%; weak investment
Migration	Control; end of free movement	Shortages; net migration higher
Union	—	Northern Ireland; Scotland
Influence	Independent voice (Ukraine)	Less weight in Europe and the world

- **Opinion**: by the early 2020s most polls showed a majority thought leaving was the **wrong decision**.

- **The reset:** the Starmer government's **UK–EU summit (May 2025)** sought closer cooperation on defence, food standards and youth mobility — an admission that the economic costs needed reducing.

VERDICT · Conclusion

Brexit gave England and the United Kingdom real advantages in sovereignty, control of EU migration, freedom to make trade deals and to regulate, and an end to EU budget payments. But the evidence since 2020 shows that these gains have been outweighed by the disadvantages: new barriers to trade with Britain's largest market, lower productivity and investment, labour shortages, strains on the Union in Northern Ireland and Scotland, and reduced influence. Brexit restored formal control at a significant economic and political cost — which is why even a government committed to it has sought a "reset" with Europe.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

Both sides fully argued and **grouped by area** · **evidence** from both before and **after 2020** (OBR, net migration, CPTPP, Windsor Framework) · a **comparison table** that weighs each area · a clear, **reasoned judgement** as "analyse with arguments" requires.

Short Notes

Reforms under David Cameron (also 2025 Q8(c))

THE QUESTION · CSS 2024 · Q7(b) · Section B · short note (10 marks)

Write a short note on: Reforms under David Cameron

David Cameron was Prime Minister from **2010 to 2016** — in **coalition** with the Liberal Democrats (2010–15), then with a Conservative majority.

- **Economy and austerity:** deficit reduction (Chancellor **George Osborne**); VAT to **20 per cent** (2011); spending cuts.
- **Welfare:** the **Welfare Reform Act (2012)** — **Universal Credit**; the **benefit cap** (2013); the tax-free allowance raised to **£11,000**; the **National Living Wage (April 2016)**.
- **Pensions:** the **triple lock**; **automatic enrolment** in workplace pensions (**2012**); pension freedoms (2015).
- **Education:** the **Academies Act (2010)** — academies and **free schools**; Michael Gove's curriculum and exam reforms; the **pupil premium** (2011); university fees up to **£9,000** (2012).
- **Health:** the **Health and Social Care Act (2012)**.
- **Society:** **same-sex marriage (2013)**; the **Modern Slavery Act (2015)**; **overseas aid** at **0.7 per cent** made law (2015); the "**Big Society**".
- **Constitution:** the **Fixed-term Parliaments Act (2011)**; the **AV referendum** (2011, rejected); the **Scottish independence referendum (2014, 55.3 per cent No)** and new powers for Scotland; English Votes for English Laws (2015); recall of MPs; the **EU referendum (2016)**.

In one line: austerity and welfare reform combined with social liberalism and constitutional change — ending with the referendum that ended his premiership.

Britain's Role in the War on Terror

THE QUESTION · CSS 2026 · Q8(a) · Section B · short note (10 marks)

Write a short note on: Britain's role in the War on Terror

- **Solidarity:** after **9/11** (11 September 2001) **Tony Blair** pledged to stand "**shoulder to shoulder**" with the USA and became its closest ally.
- **Afghanistan (2001–2021):** British forces helped overthrow the **Taliban** (2001); led the first ISAF force; fought in **Helmand** (2006–14); **457** British dead; combat ended **2014**; the Taliban returned in **August 2021**.

- **Iraq (2003–2009):** Blair argued Saddam had **WMD** (the September 2002 dossier); won a Commons vote (412–149); about **46,000** troops invaded (**20 March 2003**); Britain held **Basra**; **179** British dead; **no WMD** found; the **Chilcot Report (2016)** criticised the decision and planning.
- **At home:** anti-terror laws (2000, 2001, 2005, 2006); detention without trial (Belmarsh) and control orders; the **7/7 bombings (2005, 52 killed)**; the **Prevent** strategy.
- **Intelligence:** close cooperation through the **Five Eyes**; but complicity in **rendition** and mistreatment was later admitted.
- **Later:** air strikes against **ISIS** in Iraq (2014) and Syria (2015).
- **Consequences:** a closer special relationship but "**poodle**" criticism; damaged trust; the "Iraq syndrome" (Syria vote, 2013).

In one line: America's chief partner in Afghanistan and Iraq — at a heavy cost in lives, trust and reputation.

Lady Diana (also 2026 Q8(b): Lady Diana Spencer)

THE QUESTION · CSS 2018 · Q8(c) · Section B · short note (10 marks)

Write a short note on: Lady Diana

- **Born Diana Spencer** on **1 July 1961** at Sandringham, daughter of the 8th Earl Spencer.
- **Married Prince Charles** on **29 July 1981** at St Paul's Cathedral — watched by about **750 million** people.
- **Sons: Prince William** (1982) and **Prince Harry** (1984).
- **Humanitarian work:** challenged the stigma of **HIV/AIDS** (shaking an AIDS patient's hand without gloves, **1987**); leprosy; homelessness; children's hospitals; walked through a minefield in **Angola (January 1997)** — helping the campaign for the **Ottawa Treaty** banning landmines (December 1997).
- **The end of the marriage:** separation (**1992**); her **BBC Panorama** interview (**1995**): "There were three of us in this marriage"; divorce (**1996**).
- **Death:** killed in a car crash in **Paris** on **31 August 1997**, with Dodi Fayed, while pursued by photographers.
- **"The People's Princess"** (Tony Blair); an unprecedented outpouring of public grief; criticism of the Queen's response; funeral on **6 September 1997**.
- **Inquest (2008):** unlawful killing through the gross negligence of the driver and the pursuing paparazzi.
- **Legacy:** a more open and emotional monarchy and public culture; a global humanitarian icon.

In one line: a royal who became a global humanitarian icon, and whose death changed the way the monarchy relates to the public.

Part Two — The Past MCQs, Solved

CSS 2024 · MCQ 10

Which Prime Minister sent British troops to Iraq in 2003?

(A) John Michael	(B) Tony Blair	(C) Johnny Carlos	(D) None of these
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REMEMBER · Answer: B. Tony Blair

Tony Blair, the Labour Prime Minister, sent about 46,000 British troops to join the US-led invasion of **Iraq** in March 2003.

CSS 2025 · MCQ 15

Which party governed under Tony Blair?

(A) Conservative Party	(B) Labour Party	(C) Liberal Democrats	(D) None of these
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REMEMBER · Answer: B. Labour Party

Tony Blair led the **Labour Party** (as "New Labour") and was Prime Minister from 1997 to 2007.

CSS 2025 · MCQ 18

The global economic downturn beginning in 2008 is generally called the:

(A) Great Depression	(B) Financial Crisis	(C) Oil Crisis	(D) None of these
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REMEMBER · Answer: B. Financial Crisis

The downturn that began in 2007–08 is generally called the (global) **Financial Crisis**; the Great Depression was in the 1930s.

CSS 2025 · MCQ 20

David Cameron formed which type of government in 2010?

(A) Majority government	(B) Coalition government	(C) Minority government	(D) None of these
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REMEMBER · Answer: B. Coalition government

After the hung parliament of May 2010, David Cameron formed a **coalition government** with the Liberal Democrats.

CSS 2026 · MCQ 11

The Good Friday Agreement addressed conflict in:

(A) Wales	(B) Northern Ireland	(C) Scotland	(D) None of these
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REMEMBER · Answer: B. Northern Ireland

The **Good Friday Agreement** (10 April 1998) addressed the conflict in **Northern Ireland**, creating power-sharing government.

CSS 2026 · MCQ 12

The London 7/7 bombings occurred in:

(A) 2003	(B) 2004	(C) 2008	(D) None of these
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REMEMBER · Answer: D. None of these — 2005

The **7/7 bombings** in London took place on **7 July 2005** — none of the listed years, so the key is "None of these".

CSS 2026 · MCQ 13

The 2010 coalition government joined the Conservatives with:

(A) Labour	(B) Scottish National Party	(C) Liberal Democrats	(D) None of these
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REMEMBER · Answer: C. Liberal Democrats

The 2010 coalition joined the **Conservatives** with the **Liberal Democrats** (Nick Clegg).

CSS 2026 · MCQ 20

The 2010–15 coalition government was led by:

(A) David Cameron	(B) Nick Clegg	(C) Ed Miliband	(D) None of these
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REMEMBER · Answer: A. David Cameron

The 2010–15 coalition was led by **David Cameron** as Prime Minister, with **Nick Clegg** as his deputy.

Part Three — Five Predicted Questions, with Outlines

WHAT THE EXAMINER HAS ASKED · Why these five

They cover major themes of contemporary Britain **not yet set** as full questions.

Predicted 1 · "Assess the significance of devolution and the Good Friday Agreement for the United Kingdom."

- **Devolution** (1997–99): Scotland, Wales, London; later powers (2012, 2016).
- **The Good Friday Agreement** (1998): power-sharing; consent; north–south bodies; decommissioning; suspensions; restored 2024.
- **Significance**: peace; a quasi-federal UK; the English question; the SNP and 2014; Brexit's strains.

Predicted 2 · "Evaluate the Blair government's domestic record, 1997–2007."

- **Economy**: Bank independence; growth; light regulation.
- **Services**: NHS and schools investment; targets; PFI.
- **Poverty**: minimum wage; tax credits; Sure Start.
- **Constitution**: devolution, HRA, FOI, Lords.
- **Limits**: inequality; debt; Iraq's shadow.

Predicted 3 · "Why did Britain vote to leave the European Union in 2016?"

- Long-term Euroscepticism (Maastricht; UKIP); immigration after 2004; austerity and the "left behind"; sovereignty; distrust of elites; the campaigns ("Take Back Control"); Cameron's gamble.

Predicted 4 · "Discuss the political instability in Britain from 2016 to 2024."

- Brexit deadlock (May); Johnson's majority; Covid and partygate; Truss's mini-budget; Sunak; five PMs in eight years; causes and consequences; Labour's 2024 landslide.

Predicted 5 · "How did the Covid-19 pandemic affect British politics and society?"

- Lockdowns; furlough; vaccines; deaths; inequality; debt; partygate; the public inquiry; long-term effects on health, education and the economy.